

Psalms 57

My Heart Is Fixed

God shall send forth his mercy and truth
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Be merciful unto me, O God, be merciful unto me: for my soul trusteth in thee: yea, in the shadow of thy wings will I make my refuge, until these calamities be overpast.*
- 2 *I will cry unto God most high; unto God that performeth all things for me.*
- 3 *He shall send from heaven, and save from the reproach of him that would swallow me up. Selah. God shall send forth his mercy and his truth.*
- 4 *My soul is among lions: and I lie even among them that are set on fire, even the sons of men, whose teeth are spears and arrows, and their tongue a sharp sword.*
- 5 *Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens; let thy glory be above all the earth.*
- 6 *They have prepared a net for my steps; my soul is bowed down: they have digged a pit before me, into the midst whereof they are fallen themselves. Selah.*
- 7 *My heart is fixed, O God, my heart is fixed: I will sing and give praise.*
- 8 *Awake up, my glory; awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.*
- 9 *I will praise thee, O Lord, among the people: I will sing unto thee among the nations.*
- 10 *For thy mercy is great unto the heavens, and thy truth unto the clouds.*
- 11 *Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: let thy glory be above all the earth.*

2 · CONTEXT

Superscription places this "when he fled from Saul in the cave" (1 Sam 22 or 24). David is hemmed in by enemies pictured as lions and hunters, yet the psalm rises into some of the most exuberant praise in the Psalter, closing with the same refrain as Psalm 108. Henry notes the movement from "my soul is among lions" to "awake, psaltery and harp" as a model of worship overtaking fear.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

"Be merciful unto me, O God... my soul trusteth in thee: yea, in the shadow of thy wings will I make my refuge." He waits until calamities pass, calling to "the most high God," confident that "God shall send forth his mercy and truth" to perform all things for him.

Verse 4-6

Danger is vivid: "My soul is among lions... their teeth spears and arrows... they had prepared a net for my steps." Yet even surrounded by predators and traps, his soul is bowed down but not destroyed, and he anticipates their own snare consuming them.

Verse 7-9

Resolve breaks into song: "My heart is fixed, O God, my heart is fixed: I will sing and give praise... Awake up, my glory; awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early." He commits to praising God among the peoples and nations, not privately only.

Verse 10-11

"For thy mercy is great above the heavens, and thy truth unto the clouds. Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: let thy glory be above all the earth." The closing doxology lifts the entire psalm's gaze from personal danger to God's cosmic glory.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Even in a literal cave, surrounded by lion-like enemies, the fixed heart chooses praise as an act of will, not merely a feeling—and that praise widens from private refuge to public worship of God's mercy and glory above all the earth.

Application for life today.

In tight, dangerous, or confined seasons, practice saying "my heart is fixed" as a decision, not waiting for circumstances to justify praise. Let refuge be found "in the shadow of his wings" rather than in escaping every threat first. Consider how your private trust in hardship might become public praise that encourages others.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What "cave"—a confined, pressured season—are you currently in, and what would it mean to fix your heart in praise there?

2. How does verse 1's image of refuge "in the shadow of thy wings" shape your prayer today?

3. Where could your private trust in God become more visible praise "among the people," as verse 9 describes?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).